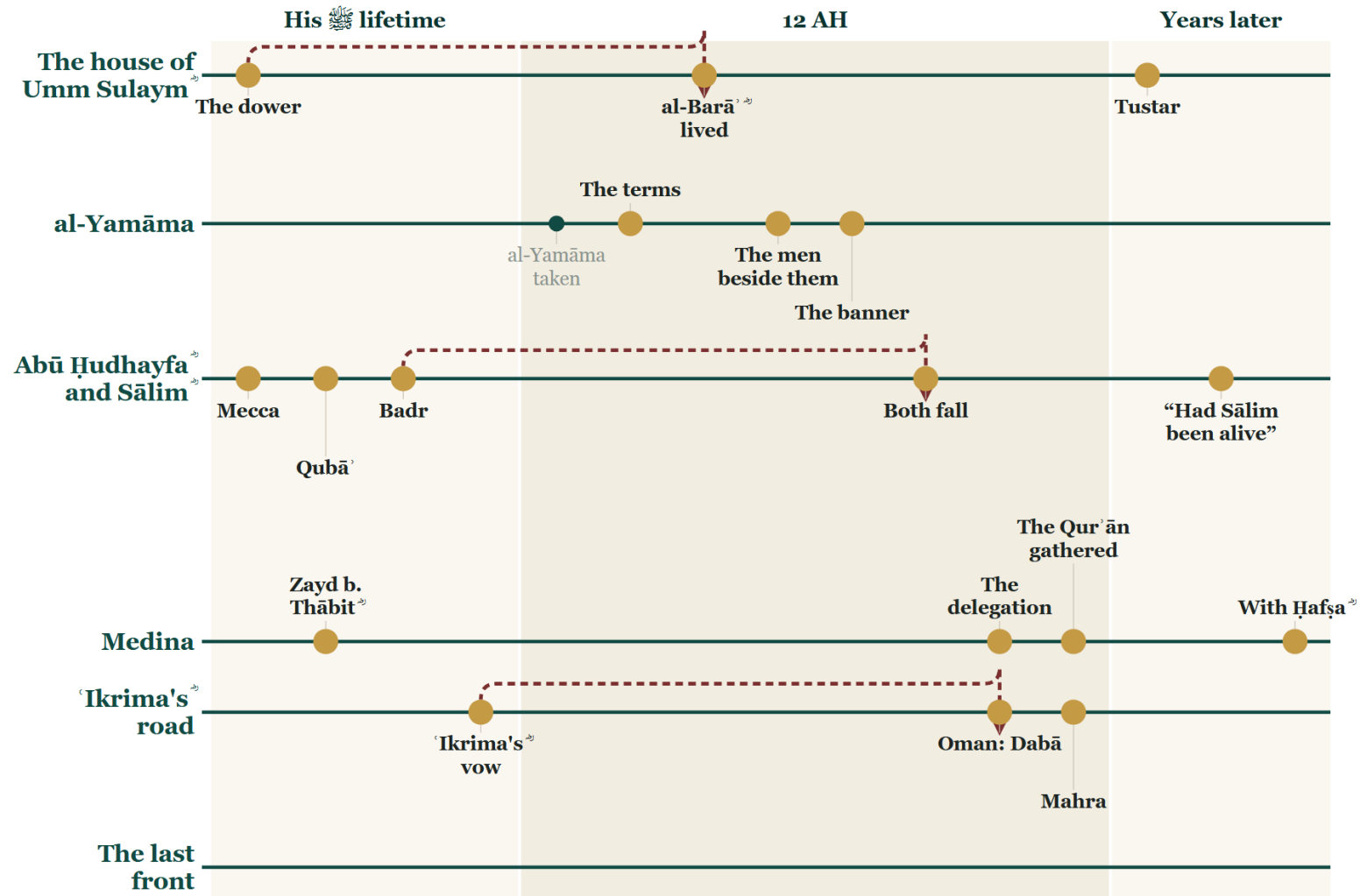


Evening 6

Bahrayn and Ḥaḍramawt

11–12 AH — the last two fronts

Where we stopped



From last week

Where we stand



Oman, Mahra
settled by ‘Ikrima ^{رضي الله عنه}
and Hudhayfa

Ḥaḍramawt
not yet told

Part I

Arabia, as the year 12 opens

12 AH, Arabia

Arabia, as the year 12 opens



Bahrayn
not yet told

Ḥaḍramawt
not yet told

12 AH, Arabia

Arabia, as the year 12 opens

اسْتُهَلَّتْ هذه السنة، وجيوشُ الصديق وأُمرأؤه الذين بعثهم لقتال أهل الرِّدة

*This year began while al-Ṣiddīq's armies and his commanders, whom he
had sent to fight the people of the ridda*

جَوَّالُونَ فِي الْبِلَادِ يَمِينًا وَشِمَالًا

were roving the land right and left

— **Ibn Kathīr, opening his chapter on the year 12**

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 61

Part II

Bahrayn: the front that began first (11→12 AH)

11 AH, the Gulf coast

From 'Ikrima's journey, to Bahrayn

Last week

'Ikrima's journey:
Oman, then Mahra

Tonight

Bahrayn — the front
that began before
them

Then

Ḥaḍramawt, the last
front

Before the conquest of Mecca

Bahrayn, in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime



| **al-Mundhir b.**

Sāwā

holds Bahrayn for
the Prophet ﷺ

| **Hajar**

its chief town

11 AH, Bahrayn

al-Mundhir b. Sāwā ٱ — and Rabīʿa



al-Jārūdٱ

holds ʿAbd al-Qays
to Islam

al-Huṭam

leads Bakr b. Wā'il
out

11 AH, Bahrayn

al-Mundhir b. Sāwā ُ — and Rabī‘a

وَاجْتَمَعَتْ رَبِيعَةُ بِالْبَحْرَيْنِ عَلَى الرِّدَّةِ

And Rabī‘a in Bahrayn agreed together upon the ridda

إِلَّا الْجَارُودُ وَمَنْ تَبِعَهُ

except al-Jārūd and those who followed him

وَقَالُوا: نَرُدُّ الْمُلْكَ

and they said: we will restore the kingship.

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on what Rabī‘a said**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 222

11 AH, Bahrayn

al-Jārūd b. al-Mu‘allā

‘Abd al-Qays were saying: had he been a prophet, he would not have died.

فَإِنَّ مُحَمَّدًا ﷺ مَاتَ كَمَا مَاتُوا

Muḥammad ﷺ has died just as they died

وَإِنِّي أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ

and I bear witness that there is no god but Allah and that

Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah.

— **al-Jārūd b. al-Mu‘allā** , to his people

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 38

11 AH, the coast of Bahrayn

al-Ḥuṭam b. Ḍubayʿa



al-Ḥuṭam

comes down at al-Qaṭīf and Hajar

Juwāthā

besieged by al-Ḥuṭam's men

al-Ḥuṭam b. Ḍubay‘a

وَخَرَجَ الْحُطَمُ بْنُ ضُبَيْعَةَ أَخُو بَنِي قَيْسِ بْنِ ثَعْلَبَةَ فِي بَكْرِ بْنِ وَائِلٍ

And al-Ḥuṭam b. Ḍubay‘a, of Banū Qays b. Tha‘laba, went out at the head of Bakr b. Wā’il

فَاجْتَمَعَ إِلَيْهِ مِنْ غَيْرِ الْمُرْتَدِّينَ مِمَّنْ لَمْ يَزَلْ مُشْرِكًا

and there gathered to him, besides the apostates, men who had never ceased to be idolaters.

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on al-Ḥuṭam**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 222

11 AH, Juwāthā

Juwāthā

Inside Juwāthā — besieged, and starving.

أَلَا أُبَلِّغُ أَبَا بَكْرٍ رَسُولًا ... وَفِتْيَانَ الْمَدِينَةِ أَجْمَعِينَ

Take a message to Abū Bakr, and to all the young men of Medina:

فَهَلْ لَكُمْ إِلَى قَوْمٍ كِرَامٍ ... قُعُودٍ فِي جُؤَاثَا مُحْصَرِينَ

*have you any thought for a noble people, sitting besieged in
Juwāthā?*

— ‘**Abd Allāh b. Ḥadhf, besieged in Juwāthā**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 222

11 AH, Medina to al-Dahnā'

al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramī ۞ — the sixteen



al-‘Alā’ ۞

sixteen riders, then
an army

al-Dahnā’

he camps in the
middle of it

11 AH, Medina to al-Dahnā'

al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramī ُ — the sixteen

فَخَرَجَ مِنَ الْمَدِينَةِ فِي سِتَّةَ عَشَرَ رَاكِبًا

He left Medina with sixteen riders

وَكَتَبَ لَهُ كِتَابًا:

and he wrote him a letter:

أَنْ يَنْفِرَ مَعَهُ كُلُّ مَنْ مَرَّ بِهِ مِنَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ إِلَى عَدُوِّهِمْ.

that every Muslim he passed should march out with him against their enemy.

— al-Dhahabī, from Ibn Sa‘d

Siyar A'lam al-Nubala, vol. 1, p. 264

11 AH, al-Dahnā' — night

al-‘Alā’ ٱ at al-Dahnā’ — three questions

Night, in the sands. The camels have bolted with all they had.

أيها الناس أَلستم المسلمين؟

O people — are you not the Muslims?

أَلستم في سبيل الله؟

Are you not in the path of Allah?

— al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramīٱ , to the army

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 39

11 AH, al-Dahnā' — night

al-‘Alā’ ٱ at al-Dahnā’ — three questions

أَلَسْتُمْ أَنْصَارَ اللَّهِ؟

Are you not the helpers of Allah?

قالوا: بلى

They said: "Yes."

— al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramīٱ , to the army

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 39

11 AH, al-Dahnā' — night

al-‘Alā’ ُ at al-Dahnā' — three questions

قال: فأبشروا فوالله لا يخذل الله من كان في مثل حالكم

He said: Then rejoice — for by Allah, Allah does not abandon those who are in a state like yours.

— al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥadramī ُ , to the army

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 39

11 AH, al-Dahnā' — dawn

al-‘Alā’ ُ at al-Dahnā' — the prayer

Dawn. An army with nothing left but its clothes.

فلما قضى الصلاة جثا على رُكبتيه وجثا الناسُ

*When he had finished the prayer he went down on his knees, and the people
went down on theirs*

ونصبَ في الدعاء ورفع يديه وفعلَ الناسُ مثله حتى طلعتِ الشمس

*he set himself to supplication and raised his hands, and the people did as he did,
until the sun rose.*

— **Ibn Kathīr, on what al-‘Alā’ ُ did at dawn**

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 39

al-‘Alā’ ُ at al-Dahnā’ — the du‘ā’

يا عليُّم، يا حليمُ، ويا عليُّ، يا عظيمُ

O All-Knowing, O Forbearing, O Most High, O Tremendous

إنا عبيدُك وفي سبيلك نقاتلُ عدوَّك

we are Your servants, and in Your path we fight Your enemy

— al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramī ُ — in another telling, that of Sahm b. Minjāb

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 6, p. 231

al-‘Alā’ ُ at al-Dahnā’ — the du‘ā’

اسقنا غيثًا نشربُ منه ونتوضأُ

give us rain from which we may drink and make wuḍū’

فإذا تركناه فلا تجعل لأحدٍ فيه نصيبًا غيرنا

and when we leave it, give no one a share in it but us

— al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramī ُ — in another telling, that of Sahm b. Minjāb

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 6, p. 231

11 AH, Hajar

Hajar — the trench month



al-ʿAlā'

camp at Hajar;
comes down from
that side

al-Jārūd

brings ʿAbd al-Qays
down from theirs

Hajar — the trench month

وَخَنَدَقَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ عَلَى أَنْفُسِهِمْ وَالْمُشْرِكُونَ

The Muslims dug a trench round themselves, and so did the mushrikūn

وَكَانُوا يَتَرَاوَحُونَ الْقِتَالَ وَيَرْجِعُونَ إِلَى خَنَدَقِهِمْ

they would fight by turns and go back to their trench

فَكَانُوا كَذَلِكَ شَهْرًا

and they went on like that for a month.

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on the trench month**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 223

11 AH, Hajar — one night

‘Abd Allāh b. Ḥadhf, and his uncle

وَاللّٰهِ اِنِّيْ لَأَظُنُّكَ بِعُسِّ ابْنِ أُخْتٍ اَتَيْتَ اللَّيْلَةَ اُخُوَالَكَ

"By Allāh, I think you a poor sort of sister's-son, coming to your uncles tonight."

— **Abjar b. Bujayr, to his sister's son**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 223

11 AH, Hajar — that night

Qays b. ‘Āṣim, and al-Ḥuṭam



al-‘Alā’

goes out at them,
over the trench

al-Ḥuṭam

killed by Qays b.
‘Āṣim

11 AH, Hajar — **that night**

Qays b. ‘Āṣim, and al-Ḥuṭam

al-Ḥuṭam mounts in the dark; his stirrup-leather parts.

‘Afīf b. al-Mundhir offers to set it right.

واسوأته، لو أعلم ما به لم أحرّكه

"What a shameful thing — had I known his condition, I would not have touched him."

— **Qays b. ‘Āṣim, standing over al-Ḥuṭam**

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 39

11–12 AH, the coast of Bahrayn

‘Utayba and al-Muthannā — the roads



the beaten
take ship for Dārīn;
the rest go home

'Utayba b. al-Nahhās
and al-Muthannā b.
Ḥāritha shut the
roads

11–12 AH, the coast of Bahrayn

‘Utayba and al-Muthannā — the roads

فَكَتَبَ الْعَلَاءُ إِلَى مَنْ ثَبَتَ عَلَى إِسْلَامِهِ مِنْ بَكْرِ بْنِ وَائِلٍ

So al-‘Alā’ wrote to those of Bakr b. Wā’il who had held firm on their Islam

مِنْهُمْ عُتَيْبَةُ بْنُ النَّهَّاسِ وَالْمُثَنَّى بْنُ حَارِثَةَ وَغَيْرُهُمَا

among them ‘Utayba b. al-Nahhās and al-Muthannā b. Ḥāritha and others

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on the letter al-‘Alā’ ۞ wrote**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 224

11–12 AH, the coast of Bahrayn

‘Utayba and al-Muthannā — the roads

يَأْمُرُهُمْ بِالْقُعُودِ لِّلْمُنْهَزِمِينَ وَالْمُرْتَدِّينَ بِكُلِّ طَرِيقٍ

*ordering them to sit in wait for the routed and the apostates on
every road.*

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on the letter al-‘Alā’ ۞ wrote**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 224

11–12 AH, the shore

al-‘Alā’ ُ at the shore

The shore opposite Dārīn. The same men who were at al-Dahnā’.

قَدْ أَرَأَكُمُ اللَّهُ مِنْ آيَاتِهِ فِي الْبَرِّ

Allah has shown you His signs on land

لِتَعْتَبِرُوا بِهَا فِي الْبَحْرِ

so that you may take heed by them at sea.

— al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramī , to the army at the shore

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 224

11–12 AH, the shore

al-‘Alā’ ٱ at the shore

فَانْهَضُوا إِلَىٰ عَدُوِّكُمْ وَاسْتَعْرِضُوا الْبَحْرَ

So rise against your enemy, and take the sea in your stride.

— al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramīٱ , to the army at the shore

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 224

11–12 AH, the shore

al-‘Alā’ ٱ — the du‘ā’

By ship, a day and a night. He rides his horse into the sea.

يا أرحمَ الراحمين، يا حكيمُ يا كريمُ

O Most Merciful of the merciful; O Wise, O Generous

يا أحدُ يا صمدُ، يا حيُّ يا مُحيي

O One, O Eternal; O Living, O Giver of life

— al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramīٱ, riding into the sea

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 40

11–12 AH, the shore

al-‘Alā’ ُ — the du‘ā’

يا قَيُّوْمُ، يا ذا الجلال والإكرام

O Sustainer; O Lord of majesty and honour

لا إله إلا أنت يا ربِّنا

there is no god but You, our Lord.

— al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramīُّ , riding into the sea

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 40

11–12 AH, Dārīn

Dārīn



| **al-'Alā'**

fords the strait, on horseback

| **Dārīn**

taken by al-'Alā', the same day

وَضَرَبَ الْإِسْلَامُ فِيهَا بِجُرَانِهِ.

"And Islam settled its neck to the ground there."

— **Ibn al-Athīr, closing the chapter**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 224

11–12 AH, Hajar

The monk of Hajar

He had been with the army through all of it.

ثَلَاثَةُ أَشْيَاءَ خَشِيتُ أَنْ يَمَسْخِنِي اللَّهُ بَعْدَهَا:

Three things, after which I feared Allah would transform me:

فَيُضُّ فِي الرَّمَالِ، وَتَمْهِدُ أَتْبَاجَ الْبَحْرِ، وَدُعَاءَ سَمْعَتِهِ فِي عَسْكَرِهِمْ فِي الْهَوَاءِ سَحَرًا
*water welling up in the sands, the levelling of the sea's swells, and a
supplication I heard in their camp, in the air, before dawn.*

— **A monk of Hajar, asked why he became a Muslim**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 224

12 AH, the road from Dārīn

Thumāma b. Uthāl

On the road home, wearing a cloak from the spoils. It had been al-Ḥuṭam's.

فَقَالُوا لَهُ: أَنْتَ قَتَلْتَ الْحُطَمَ! فَقَالَ: لَمْ أَقْتُلْهُ، وَلَكِنِّي اشْتَرَيْتُهَا مِنَ الْمَغْنَمِ.

They said to him: You killed al-Ḥuṭam! He said: I did not kill him — I bought it from the spoils.

فَوَثَبُوا عَلَيْهِ فَقَتَلُوهُ.

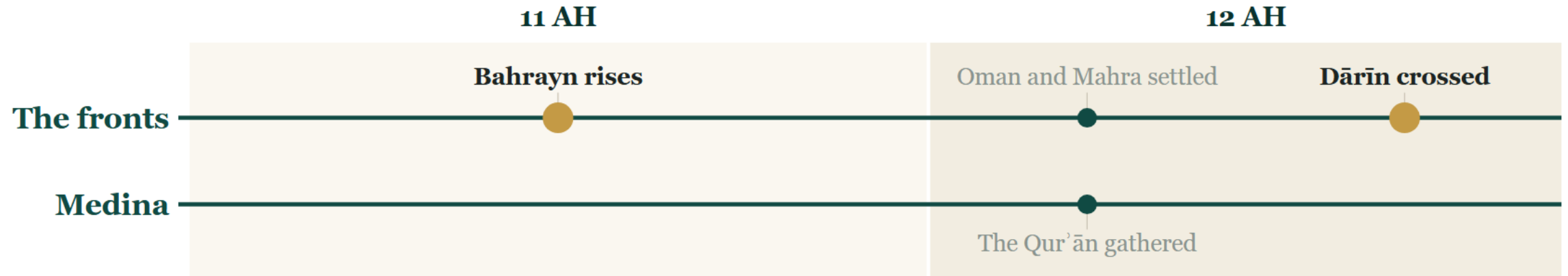
So they fell on him and killed him.

— Banū Qays b. Tha‘laba, and Thumāma

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 224

So far tonight

Where we stand



So far tonight

Where we stand



Bahrayn

held again, by al-
'Alā' ٱ

Ḥaḍramawt

not yet told

Part III

Kinda, before any of it (10 AH)

10 AH, Medina

Kinda, two years earlier

Two years earlier

the delegation of
Kinda comes to
Medina

At its head

al-Ash‘ath b. Qays

Then

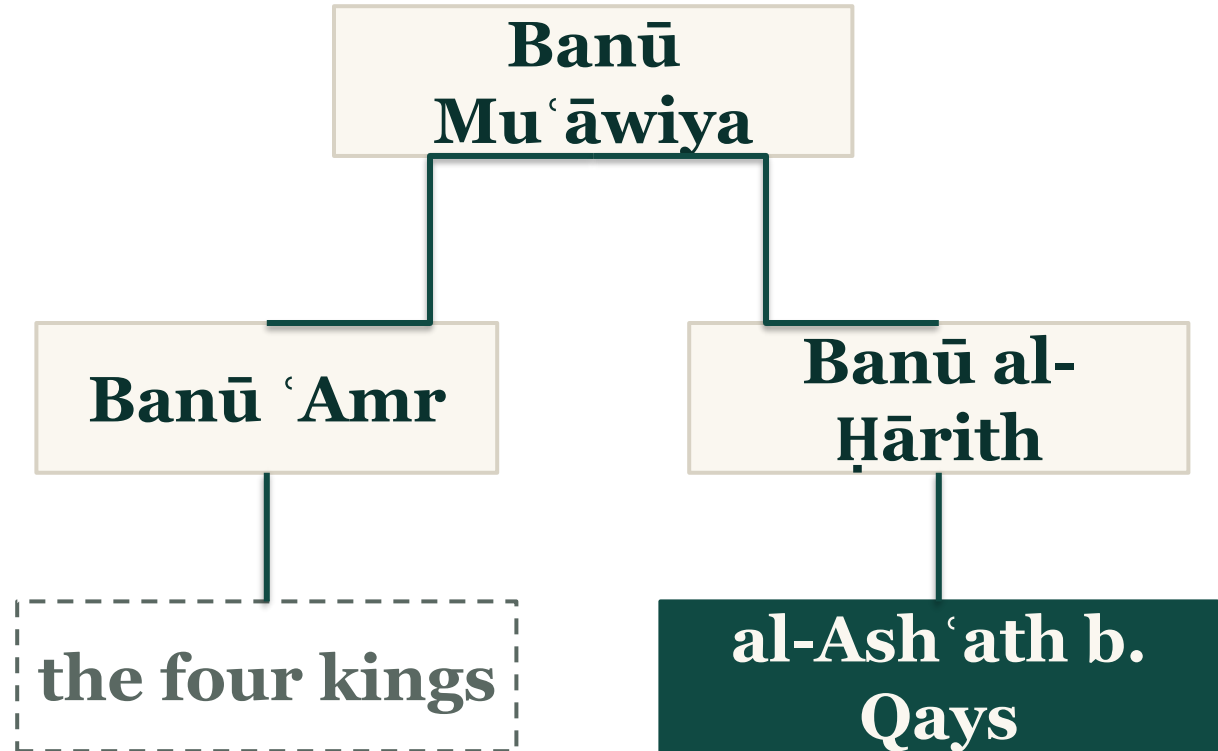
forward again, to
Ḥaḍramawt

kings once — and two branches in 11 AH

Kinda

Ākil al-Murār

kings of the north,
before Islam



10 AH, Medina

al-Ash'ath b. Qays — at Medina

The delegation of Kinda, in silk. al-Ash'ath claims a shared royal ancestor.

لا، نحن بنو النَّضْر بن كنانة

No. We are the sons of al-Naḍr b. Kināna.

لا نَقْفُو أُمَّنَا، ولا ننتفي من أبينا

*We do not trace ourselves through our mother, and we do not
disown our father.*

— The Prophet ﷺ, to the delegation of Kinda

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 5, p. 56

Part IV

Ḥaḍramawt: the last front (11 → 12 AH)

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

Ziyād b. Labīdؓ , in Ḥaḍramawt



Ḥaḍramawt

Ziyād b. Labīdؓ , the Prophet's ﷺ governor

Kinda

its neighbour

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

Ziyād b. Labīdٌ , in Ḥaḍramawt

قَالَتْ بَنُو وَلَيْعَةَ: أَبْلِغُونَا كَمَا وَعَدْتُمُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ – صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ –!

Banū Walī‘a said: Deliver it to us, as you promised the Messenger of Allah ﷺ!

فَقَالُوا: إِنَّ لَكُمْ ظَهْرًا فَاحْتَمِلُوا

They said: You do have mounts — carry it yourselves.

— **Banū Walī‘a, to the men of Ḥaḍramawt**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 230

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

Ziyād b. Labīd ُ — and Shadhra

A she-camel, branded for the ṣadaqa by mistake. Ziyād ُ will not give her back.

فَقَالَ حَارِثَةُ: ذَاكَ إِذَا كُنْتَ يَهُودِيًّا

Ḥāritha said: That would be so if you were a Jew

وَأَطْلَقَ عِقَالَهَا وَبَعَثَهَا وَقَامَ دُونَهَا.

and he untied her hobble and drove her off and stood in front of her.

— **Ḥāritha b. Surāqa, to Ziyād b. Labīdُ**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 230

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-‘Addā’, and Ḥāritha b. Surāqa



Ziyād b.

Labīd

with Ḥaḍramawt
and al-Sakūn

Banū

Mu‘āwiya

of Kinda, come out
for Ḥāritha

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-‘Addā’, and Ḥāritha b. Surāqa

فَنَادَى الْعَدَاءُ: يَا آلَ عَمْرِو، أَضَامُ وَأُضْطَهَدُ!

Al-‘Addā’ called out: O family of ‘Amr — am I to be wronged and trampled?

إِنَّ الذَّلِيلَ مَنْ أَكَلَ فِي دَارِهِ!

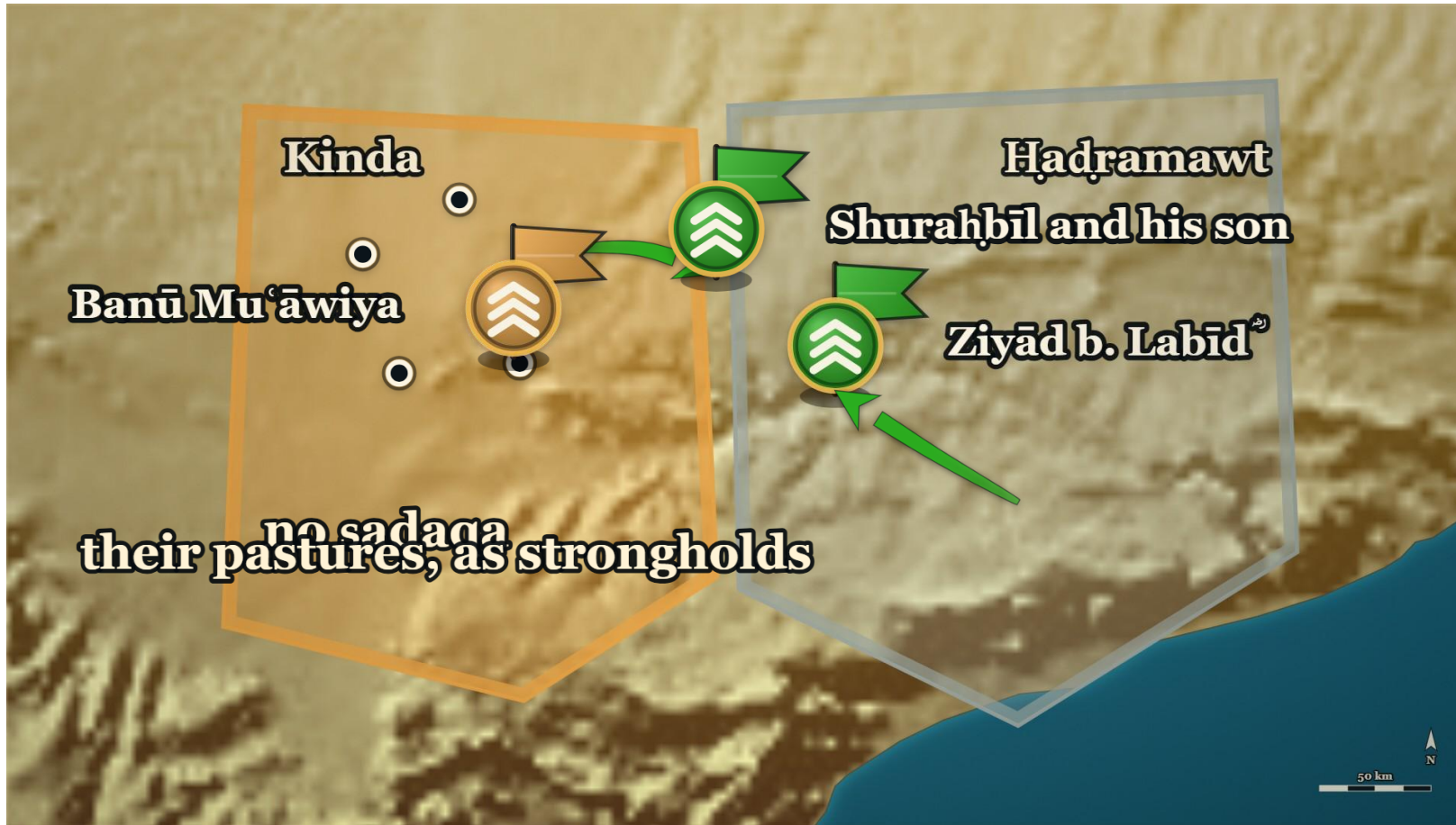
The humbled man is the one who is devoured in his own home!

— al-‘Addā’, calling to his clan

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 230

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

Shuraḥbīl b. al-Simt, and his son



Banū

Muʿāwiya

each chief holds his own pasture

Shuraḥbīl and

his son

go over to Ziyād

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

Shuraḥbīl b. al-Simt, and his son

إِنَّهُ لَقَبِيحٌ بِالْأَحْرَارِ التَّنَقُّلُ

It is an ugly thing in free men to change sides.

إِنَّ الْكِرَامَ لَيَلْزِمُونَ الشُّبُهَةَ

Men of honour will stay with a doubtful position

— **Shuraḥbīl b. al-Simt and his son, to their clan**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 231

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

Shuraḥbīl b. al-Simt, and his son

فَيَتَكَرَّمُونَ أَنْ يَنْتَقِلُوا إِلَى أَوْضَحَ مِنْهَا مَخَافَةَ الْعَارِ

*and think it beneath them to move even to a clearer one, for fear of the
disgrace*

فَكَيْفَ الْإِنْتِقَالُ مِنَ الْأَمْرِ الْحَسَنِ الْجَمِيلِ وَالْحَقِّ إِلَى الْبَاطِلِ وَالْقَبِيحِ!

*so how much worse to move from what is good, fair and true to what is
false and ugly!*

— **Shuraḥbīl b. al-Simt and his son, to their clan**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 231

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

The four kings — Mikhwaṣ, Mishraḥ, Jamad, Abdaʿa



Ziyād b.

Labīd

strikes at night,
from five sides

the four kings

killed by Ziyād's
men, at their fires

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

The four kings — Mikhwaṣ, Mishraḥ, Jamad, Abḍa‘a

فَوَجَدُوهُمْ جُلُوسًا حَوْلَ نِيرَانِهِمْ

They found them sitting round their fires

فَأَكْبُوا عَلَى بَنِي عَمْرِو بْنِ مُعَاوِيَةَ، وَفِيهِمُ الْعَدَدُ وَالشُّوْكَةُ – مِنْ خَمْسَةِ أَوْجِهٍ

and fell on Banū ‘Amr b. Mu‘āwiya — who had the numbers and the strength — from five directions.

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on that night**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 231

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-Ash‘ath b. Qays — the column he

stopped



the captives
taken by Ziyād , on
the road home

al-Ash‘ath b.
Qays
rises, and takes
them back

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-Ash‘ath b. Qays — the column he stopped

وَعَادَ زِيَادُ بْنُ لَبِيدٍ بِالْأَمْوَالِ وَالسَّبْيِ

Ziyād b. Labīd returned with the property and the captives

وَاجْتَاوُوا بِالْأَشْعَثِ

and they passed by al-Ash‘ath

فَنَارَ فِي قَوْمِهِ، فَاسْتَنْقَذَهُمْ وَجَمَعَ الْجُمُوعَ.

so he rose with his people, recovered them, and gathered the gatherings.

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on al-Ash‘ath**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 231

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-Muhājir ۞ and ʿIkrima ۞ — to al-Nujayr



al-Muhājir ۞
from Ṣanʿāʾ, ahead
of his army

ʿIkrima ۞
with the main body

al-Nujayr
the fort

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-Muhājir ۞ and ‘Ikrima ۞ — to al-Nujayr

فَرَجَعُوا إِلَىٰ حِصْنِهِمْ، وَخَشَعَتْ نُفُوسُهُمْ وَخَافُوا الْقَتْلَ

"They went back into their fort; their spirits sank, and they feared death."

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on al-Nujayr**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 231

11 or 12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-Nujayr — the siege



al-Muhājir

with Ziyād ,
besieges Kinda in
the fort

'Ikrima

brings up the main
body

11 or 12 AH, al-Nujayr

al-Ash‘ath b. Qays — and Jaḥdam

Inside al-Nujayr. al-Ash‘ath writes the names of the men to be spared.

وَنَسِيَ الْأَشْعَثُ أَنْ يَكْتُبَ نَفْسَهُ لِأَنَّ جَحْدَمًا وَثَبَ عَلَيْهِ بِسِكِّينٍ، فَقَالَ: تَكْتُبُنِي أَوْ أَقْتُلُكَ؟

Al-Ash‘ath forgot to write himself in, because Jaḥdam leapt at him with a knife and said: Will you write me in, or shall I kill you?

فَكَتَبَهُ وَنَسِيَ نَفْسَهُ

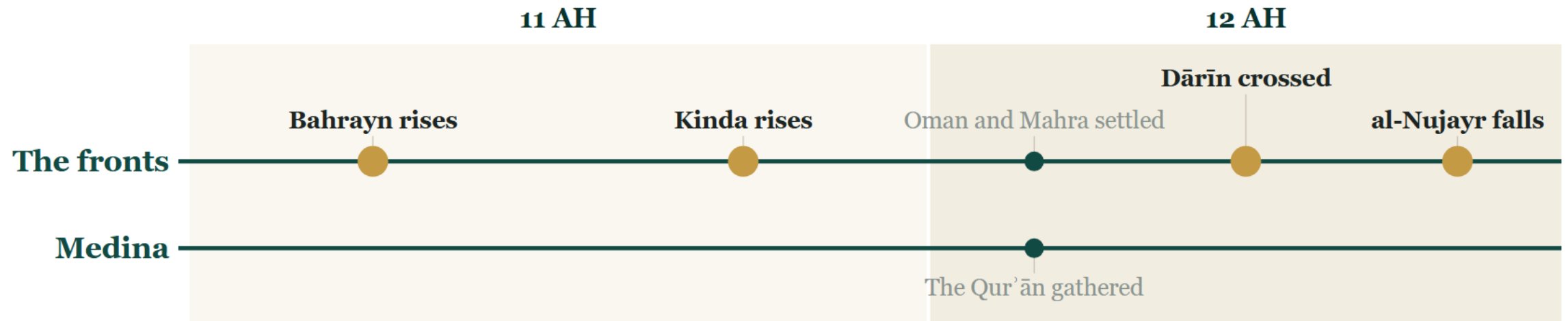
So he wrote him in, and forgot himself.

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on the writing**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 232

So far tonight

Where we stand



So far tonight

Where we stand



al-Nujayr

opened to Ziyād ٱ and al-Muhājirٱ

al-Ash‘ath

sent to Medina in bonds

Part V

Medina, and after (12 AH → years later)

12 AH, Medina

Abū Bakr   and al-Ash‘ath, at Medina

al-Ash‘ath, in bonds, argues that the truce covers him.

قَالَ: إِنَّمَا وَجَبَ الصُّلْحُ بَعْدَ خَتْمِ الصَّحِيفَةِ عَلَى مَنْ فِيهَا

*He said: The peace became binding, once the document was sealed,
only on those named in it*

وإِنَّمَا كُنْتُ قَبْلَ ذَلِكَ مُرَاوِضًا.

before that you were only negotiating.

— **Abū Bakr  , to al-Ash‘ath**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 232

12 AH, Medina

al-Ash'ath ٱ — pardoned, and married

Pardoned, and married to Abū Bakr's ٱ sister.

وَاللّٰهُ مَا كَفَرْتُ؛ وَلَكِنَّ هَٰذَا الرَّجُلَ زَوَّجَنِي أُخْتَهُ

By God, I have not disbelieved. This man has married his sister to me

وَلَوْ كُنَّا فِي بِلَادِنَا لَكَانَتْ لَنَا وَلِيْمَةٌ غَيْرُ هَٰذِهِ

*and had we been in our own country we would have had a wedding feast
other than this one.*

— al-Ash'ath ٱ , in the market at Medina

Siyar A'lam al-Nubala, vol. 2, p. 39

12 AH, Medina

al-Ash'ath ُ — pardoned, and married

يَا أَهْلَ الْمَدِينَةِ، انْحَرُّوا، وَكُلُّوا! وَيَا أَهْلَ الْإِبِلِ تَعَالَوْا خُذُوا شَرَوَاهَا!

*People of Medina — slaughter and eat! And owners of the camels,
come and take the like of them!*

— al-Ash'ath ُ , in the market at Medina

Siyar A'lam al-Nubala, vol. 2, p. 39

Years later: al-Qādisiyya, Nahāwand

Ṭulayḥa , ‘Amr and Qays

Years later. Three men who had once turned, now in the army.

ولقد اتهمنا ثلاثة نفر

We did suspect three men

فما رأينا كما هجمنا عليهم من أمانتهم وزهدهم:

*and when we came upon them we found nothing to match their
trustworthiness and their abstinence:*

— **Jābir b. ‘Abd Allāh , of the army at al-Qādisiyya**

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 243

Years later: al-Qādisiyya, Nahāwand

Ṭulayḥa , ‘Amr and Qays

طُلَيْحَةُ بْنُ خُوَيْلِدِ الْأَسَدِيِّ، وَعَمْرُو بْنُ مَعْدِي كَرِبٍ، وَقَيْسُ بْنُ الْمَكْشُوحِ.

Ṭulayḥa b. Khuwaylid al-Asadī, ‘Amr b. Ma‘dī Karib, and Qays b. al-Makshūḥ.

— **Jābir b. ‘Abd Allāh** , of the army at al-Qādisiyya

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 243

Years later

al-Ash‘ath ٱ and Jarīr b. ‘Abd Allāhٱ

A funeral, years later. al-Ash‘ath ٱ steps back for Jarīrٱ .

إِنَّ هَذَا لَمْ يَرْتَدَّ، وَإِنِّي ارْتَدَدْتُ.

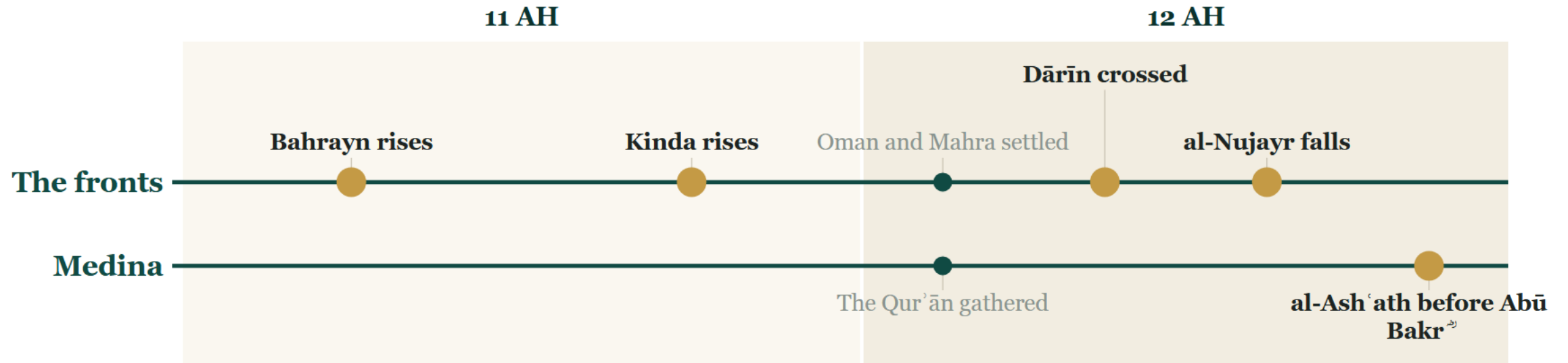
"This man did not apostatise. And I did."

— al-Ash‘athٱ , of Jarīr b. ‘Abd Allāhٱ

Siyar A'lam al-Nubala, vol. 2, p. 40

So far tonight

Where we stand



So far tonight

Where we stand



Arabia

one colour, in two years

al-Ash‘ath

pardoned by Abū Bakr

Part VI

Medina, 12 AH: Ibn Kathīr and Ibn Mas'ūd on the whole war

12 AH, the whole peninsula

Ibn Kathīr, on the whole war

Ibn Kathīr has finished telling the war. He stops, and says what it was.

ما من ناحية من جزيرة العرب إلا وحصلَ في أهلها ردَّةٌ لبعض الناس

*There was no region of the Arabian peninsula in which apostasy did not occur
among some of its people*

فبعثَ الصِّدِّيقُ إليهم جيوشًا وأمراءَ يَكُونُونَ عونًا لمن في تلك الناحية من المؤمنين

*so al-Ṣiddīq sent them armies and commanders to be a support to whichever
believers were in that region*

— **Ibn Kathīr, summing up the war**

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 43

‘Abd Allāh b. Mas‘ūdؓ

Ibn al-Athīr opens his whole chapter on the war with these words.

لَقَدْ قُومْنَا بَعْدَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - مَقَامًا كِدْنَا نَهْلِكُ فِيهِ

*We stood, after the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, in a position in which we nearly
perished*

لَوْلَا أَنَّ اللَّهَ مَنَّ عَلَيْنَا بِأَبِي بَكْرٍ

had Allah not favoured us with Abū Bakr.

— ‘Abd Allāh b. Mas‘ūdؓ

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 201

‘Abd Allāh b. Mas‘ūdؓ

أَجْمَعْنَا عَلَى أَنْ لَا نُقَاتِلَ عَلَى ابْنَةِ مَخَاضٍ وَابْنَةِ لُبُونٍ

We had all agreed not to fight over a yearling she-camel or a two-year-old

وَأَنْ نَأْكُلَ قُرَى عَرَبِيَّةً، وَنَعْبُدَ اللَّهَ حَتَّى يَأْتِينَا الْيَقِينُ

and to live off the Arab towns, and to worship Allah until the certainty came to us.

— ‘Abd Allāh b. Mas‘ūdؓ

فَعَزَمَ اللَّهُ لِأَبِي بَكْرٍ عَلَى قِتَالِهِمْ

Then Allah gave Abū Bakr the resolve to fight them

فَوَاللَّهِ مَا رَضِيَ مِنْهُمْ إِلَّا بِالْخُطَّةِ الْمُخْزِيَةِ أَوْ الْحَرْبِ الْمُجْلِيَةِ

and by Allah, he accepted nothing from them but the humiliating terms, or the war that drives out.

— ‘Abd Allāh b. Mas‘ūdؓ

Abū Bakrؓ , and the men of Badr

On who was given command — and who was not.

لَا أَسْتَعْمِلُ أَهْلَ بَدْرٍ، أَدْعُهُمْ حَتَّى يَلْقُوا اللَّهَ بِصَالِحِ أَعْمَالِهِمْ

*I do not put the men of Badr into office. I leave them so they may meet Allah
with their good deeds*

فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ يَدْفَعُ بِهِمْ وَبِالصَّالِحِينَ أَكْثَرَ مِمَّا يَنْتَصِرُ بِهِمْ.

*for Allah wards off by them and by the righteous more than He gives victory
through them.*

— **Abū Bakr ؓ** — and, beside it, ‘**Umar's ؓ** view

Abū Bakrؓ , and the men of Badr

وَكَانَ عُمَرُ يَرَى اسْتِعْمَالَهُمْ عَلَى الْجُنْدِ وَغَيْرِهِ.

And ‘Umar held that they should be employed over the troops and otherwise.

— Abū Bakrؓ — and, beside it, ‘Umar'sؓ view

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 215

11 AH, Dhū al-Qaṣṣa

The eleven banners, from Dhū al-Qaṣṣa

IMAGE GOES HERE

Eleven plain cloth banners on spear-shafts, planted upright in a row on open stony ground at first light, each a different muted colour, stirring slightly in the wind; a low line of dark hills behind. Nothing else on the

Dhū al-Qaṣṣa

eleven banners, tied by Abū Bakrؓ

‘Umar's ﷺ caliphate, Medina

‘Umar ﷺ — the captives bought back

Years later, the captives of these wars are still held.

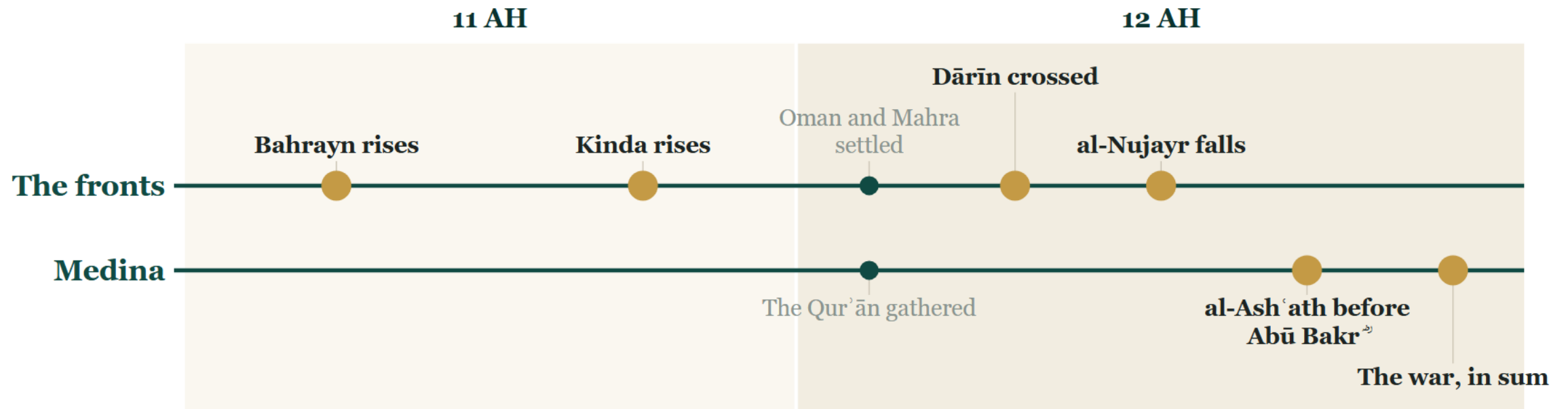
إِنَّهُ لَقَبِيحٌ بِالْعَرَبِ أَنْ يَمْلِكَ بَعْضُهُمْ بَعْضًا

"It is a shameful thing for the Arabs that some of them should own others."

— ‘Umar ﷺ, as caliph

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 232

Tonight on the Line



12 AH, Arabia

Where we stand



Bahrayn

held again, by al-'Alā

Ḥaḍramawt

taken by Ziyād and al-Muhājir

Tonight

- | Bahrayn
- | al-Dahnā'
- | Ḥaḍramawt
- | al-Ash'ath^{رض}
- | Ibn Mas'ūd^{رض} , on the war

Next week

Two years after the Prophet ﷺ died, all of Arabia was on one side. There were two empires on the other side of the desert. Did either of them know?

Part VII

Persia and Rome: the other side of the desert (12 AH)

12 AH, the other side of the desert

Persia and Rome — beyond Arabia



PERSIA

al-Madā'in — the house of Kistrā

ROME

Heraclius — Syria is his

12–13 AH, al-Madā'in

The house of Kistrā

Shīrā, Kistrā's son, had killed the males of his own house.

Persia's great men ask its women for one heir.

لَمْ يَبْقَ إِلَّا غُلَامٌ يُدْعَى يَزْدَجَرْدَ مِنْ وَلَدِ شَهْرِيَّارِ بْنِ كِسْرَى، وَأُمُّهُ مِنْ أَهْلِ بَادُورِيَا.

“None is left but a boy called Yazdagird, of the line of Shahriyār son of Kistrā; his mother is of the people of Bādūrayā.”

فَأَرْسَلُوا إِلَيْهَا وَطَلَبُوهُ مِنْهَا

So they sent to her and asked her for him.

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on how Persia found its last king**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 284

The house of Kisrā

وَكَانَتْ قَدْ أَنْزَلَتْهُ أَيَّامَ شِيرَى حِينَ جَمَعَهُنَّ فَقَتَلَ الذُّكُورَ، وَأَرْسَلَتْهُ إِلَى أَخْوَالِهِ

She had got him away in the days of Shīrā — when he gathered them and killed the males — and had sent him to his mother's brothers.

فَلَمَّا سَأَلُوهَا عَنْهُ دَلَّتْهُمْ عَلَيْهِ، فَجَاءُوا بِهِ فَمَلَّكُوهُ وَهُوَ ابْنُ إِحْدَى وَعِشْرِينَ سَنَةً

When they asked her about him she led them to him; and they brought him and made him king, at twenty-one.

— **Ibn al-Athīr, on how Persia found its last king**

Part VIII

Medina, Iraq and Syria: two letters leave, and what each empire heard (12–13 AH)

Muḥarram 12 AH, al-Yamāma to Iraq

Khālīd ٱ — the order to Iraq



Khālīd ٱ

ordered to Iraq,
from its lower end

al-Madā'in

Persia's capital —
he is not sent there

Khālīd ٱ — the order to Iraq

وَأَنْ يَتَأَلَّفَ النَّاسَ وَيَدْعُوهُمْ إِلَى اللَّهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ

...that he should win the people over and call them to God

فَإِنْ أَجَابُوا وَإِلَّا أَخَذَ مِنْهُمْ الْجِزْيَةَ فَإِنْ امْتَنَعُوا عَنْ ذَلِكَ قَاتِلْهُمْ

if they answered, well, and if not, take the jizya from them; and if they refused that, fight them.

— Ibn Kathīr, on what Abū Bakr ٱ ordered Khālīd ٱ

Muḥarram 12 AH, al-Yamāma to Iraq

Khālīd   — the order to Iraq

وأمره أن لا يُكرِه أحدًا على المسير معه

And he ordered him not to compel anyone to march with him

ولا يستعينُ بمن ارتدَّ عن الإسلام وإن كان [قد] عاد إليه

*and not to make use of any man who had apostatised from Islam,
even if he had returned to it.*

— **Ibn Kathīr, on what Abū Bakr   ordered Khālīd  **

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 62

Early 13 AH, Medina

Syria — four commanders, four roads



Medina

four commanders
leave by four roads

Syria

four provinces
given, none yet
taken

Early 13 AH, Medina

Syria — four commanders, four roads

وَقَالَ يَا بَنِيَّ لَا تَدْخُلُوا

O my sons, do not enter

مِنْ بَابٍ وَاحِدٍ وَادْخُلُوا مِنْ أَبْوَابٍ مُتَفَرِّقَةٍ

by one gate; enter by separate gates

— Ya‘qūb, peace be upon him, to his sons — Sūrat Yūsuf 67

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, pp. 83–84

13 AH, leaving Medina

Abū Bakrؓ , to Yazīd b. Abī Sufyānؓ

Abū Bakrؓ , on foot, beside Yazīd's ؓ horse.

إِنِّي قَدْ وَلَّيْتُكَ لِأَبْلُوكَ وَأُجَرِّبَكَ وَأُخْرِجَكَ

I have put you in office to test you, to try you and to bring you out.

فَإِنْ أَحْسَنْتَ رَدَدْتُكَ إِلَى عَمَلِكَ وَزِدْتُكَ، وَإِنْ أَسَأْتَ عَزَلْتُكَ

*If you do well I will return you to your post and add to it; and if you
do badly I will dismiss you*

— **Abū Bakrؓ , to Yazīd b. Abī Sufyānؓ**

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 249

13 AH, leaving Medina

Abū Bakrؓ , to Yazīd b. Abī Sufyānؓ

... فَإِيَّاكَ وَعُيَّةَ الْجَاهِلِيَّةِ، فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ يُبْغِضُهَا وَيُبْغِضُ أَهْلَهَا

*... And beware the arrogance of the Jāhiliyya — God hates it, and
hates those who carry it.*

— Abū Bakrؓ , to Yazīd b. Abī Sufyānؓ

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 249

‘Amr b. al-‘Āṣ̣ — one arrow

Offered the Syrian command — and left free to keep the post he had.

إِنِّي سَهْمٌ مِنْ سِهَامِ الْإِسْلَامِ

I am one arrow of the arrows of Islam

وَأَنْتَ بَعْدَ اللَّهِ الرَّامِي بِهَا وَالْجَامِعُ لَهَا

*and you — after God — are the one who shoots them and the one
who gathers them.*

— ‘Amr b. al-‘Āṣ̣ , to Abū Bakṛ

‘Amr b. al-‘Āṣؓ — one arrow

فَانْظُرْ أَشَدَّهَا وَأَخْشَاهَا وَأَفْضَلَهَا فَارْمِ بِهِ

*So look for the hardest of them, and the most feared, and the best,
and shoot it.*

— ‘Amr b. al-‘Āṣؓ , to Abū Bakrؓ

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 249

12 AH, lower Iraq

Khālīd ٱ — the letter to al-Madā'in



Khālīd ٱ

writes to al-Madā'in; he does not march

al-Madā'in

Kisrā's commanders, marzubāns and ministers

12 AH, lower Iraq

Khālīd ٱ — the letter to al-Madā'in

فابعثوا إليّ بالرُّهْن واعتقدوا مني الذِّمَّة

...so send me hostages and take a covenant of protection from me.

و (إلا) فوالذي لا إله غيره

Otherwise — by Him beside whom there is no god

لأبعثن إليكم قومًا يحبُّون الموتَ كما تحبُّون أنتم الحياة

I shall send against you a people who love death as you love life.

— Khālīd b. al-Walīdٱ , to the marzubāns of Persia

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 64

13 AH, Syria

Heraclius, to the Romans

The four columns are on the road. The Romans write to their emperor.

وَيُحْكَمُ إِنْ (هَؤُلَاءِ) أَهْلُ دِينٍ جَدِيدٍ

Woe to you — these are the people of a new religion

وَأَنَّهُمْ لَا قِبَلَ لِأَحَدٍ بِهِمْ

and no one has the strength to face them.

— **Heraclius, to the Romans** — as Ibn Kathīr reports it

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 86

13 AH, Syria

Heraclius, to the Romans

فأطيعوني وصالحوهم بما تصالحونهم على نصف خراج الشام ويبقى لكم جبال الروم

So obey me, and make peace with them — on half the revenue of Syria, and the mountains of the Romans remain yours.

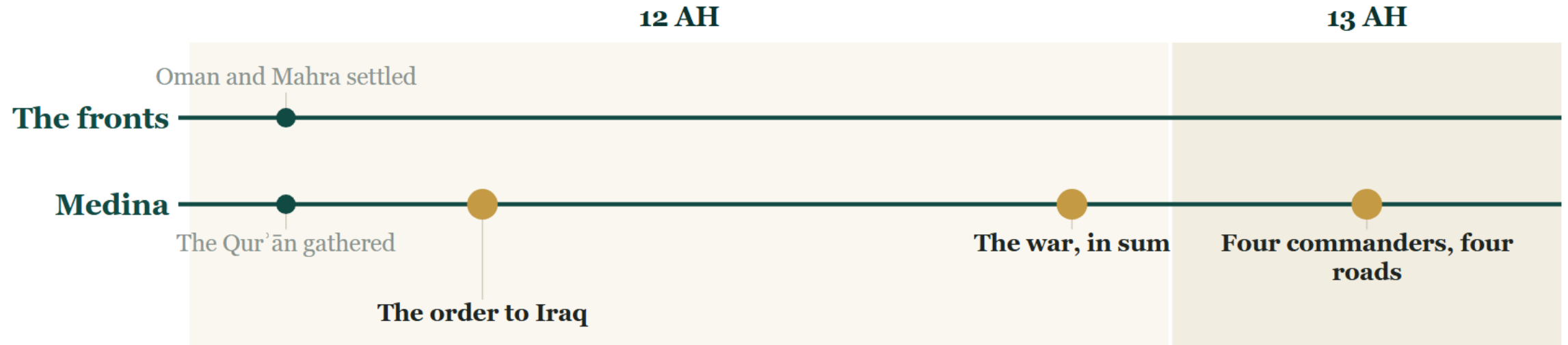
وإن أنتم أبيتم ذلك أخذوا منكم الشام وضيقوا عليكم جبال الروم

If you refuse that, they will take Syria from you, and press you hard in the mountains of the Romans.

— Heraclius, to the Romans — as Ibn Kathīr reports it

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 86

Tonight on the Line



13 AH, beyond Arabia

Where we stand



Iraq

Khālīd ٱ at its lower end; a letter

Syria

four commanders,
four roads —
nothing taken

Tonight

| Persia

| Iraq

| Syria

| Yazīd^{رضي}

| Rome

Next week

The emperor of the Romans told them:
make peace. They refused him. What did
it cost them?